

CivicSync — SIH Judge Question Bank

Problem Statement 26043 • Mind Mavericks

A. Problem & Need

1. What exact problem are you solving?
2. Why is this problem important?
3. Why can't existing platforms solve this?
4. Why did you choose this problem statement?
5. Who are your target users?
6. Who is the actual problem owner?
7. How did you identify this gap?
8. What happens currently when a citizen reports a problem?
9. Why are existing grievance platforms insufficient?
10. Why is this relevant to Smart Education?

B. Innovation

11. Isn't CivicSync just an integration of existing platforms?
12. What exactly did your team innovate?
13. What is your USP?
14. What part of CivicSync doesn't already exist?
15. Why would someone use CivicSync instead of CPGRAMS/MyGov?
16. How is it different from an expert directory?
17. How is it different from an innovation marketplace?
18. How is it different from LinkedIn?
19. How is it different from ChatGPT?
20. What is your biggest differentiating factor?

C. Smart Education & Student Innovation

21. Where exactly is the student innovation in your platform?
22. Why would students participate?
23. What does a student actually gain?
24. How does CivicSync generate student projects?
25. How does a student find a problem relevant to their skills?
26. How do students collaborate with faculty/researchers?
27. How do you verify a student's contribution?

- 28. How does the Impact Passport help students?
- 29. Can students get academic credit through CivicSync?

D. AI

- 30. Are you actually using AI?
- 31. Why call it AI if it is rule-based?
- 32. Why didn't you use ChatGPT or an LLM?
- 33. What exactly does your AI analyze?
- 34. How does your AI understand Hindi/Hinglish?
- 35. How does it identify the required expertise?
- 36. What happens if the AI gives the wrong classification?
- 37. How do you measure AI accuracy?
- 38. Can your AI scale to millions of problems?

E. Problem Clustering & Priority

- 39. How do you detect duplicate problems?
- 40. What happens if 50 people report the same problem?
- 41. How do you differentiate between duplicate and related problems?
- 42. How do you prioritize problems?
- 43. Why not simply use upvotes?
- 44. What if a serious rural problem receives very few votes?
- 45. Can users manipulate the priority score?

F. Matching

- 46. How do you match a problem with the right student/expert?
- 47. What data do you use for matching?
- 48. How do you know someone's actual expertise?
- 49. What if no suitable expert exists?
- 50. What is an explainable match?
- 51. How is the matching score calculated?
- 52. Is your expert database real?
- 53. Do you have a national database of students and experts?
- 54. How will you build the capability database at scale?
- 55. Why would universities share their data?

G. Solution, Implementation & Impact

- 56. Who decides which solution is best?

57. Can AI select the final solution?
58. How do you evaluate a student's solution?
59. What if AI gives a high score to a bad solution?
60. Who validates the solution?
61. Why involve startups/MSMEs?
62. How does a solution move from prototype to implementation?
63. How do you select an implementation partner?
64. Are you replacing government procurement?
65. How do you know a problem was actually solved?
66. What evidence do you collect?
67. How do you verify evidence?
68. What is Evidence Confidence?
69. What is an Impact Score?
70. What is an Impact Passport?
71. Can someone fake impact data?
72. How do you prevent fake reviews/evidence?
73. Can you claim real-world impact from your demo data?

H. Most Important Technical Questions

1. Explain the complete technical flow of CivicSync from problem submission to impact measurement.
2. Why did you use a separate Python/FastAPI AI service with a Node.js backend?
3. How does your current rule-based AI actually classify and structure a citizen's problem?
4. How does CivicSync understand English, Hindi and Hinglish problem descriptions?
5. How does your duplicate detection and problem clustering work?
6. How exactly does your expert/capability matching algorithm work?
7. How is the matching score calculated, and why is it explainable?
8. How is your priority score different from simply counting upvotes?
9. What happens if your AI gives the wrong classification, expertise or severity?
10. Why didn't you use an LLM, and how would you upgrade your current system to ML/LLM later?
11. How does your system maintain the complete chain: Problem → Solution → Implementation → Evidence → Impact Passport?
12. If CivicSync gets millions of users and problems, how will you scale the architecture?

I. Other Important Judge Questions

13. What is currently implemented, and what is only proposed or future scope?
14. Which features in your demo are simplified or simulated?
15. How will you protect citizen data and privacy?
16. How will you prevent fake problems, fake voting and gaming?
17. What is your revenue model?
18. Who will pay for CivicSync?
19. Why would startups/MSMEs join your platform?
20. Why would universities join?
21. How will you acquire your first users?
22. What is your adoption strategy?
23. What are your biggest technical challenges?
24. Is this actually feasible at national scale?

J. Questions to Prepare for Most

1. "Isn't your entire project just integration?"
2. "Where is the actual innovation?"
3. "Why is this Smart Education and not Smart Governance?"
4. "Your AI is only rule-based. Why should we consider this an AI solution?"
5. "Your expert matching database is synthetic. How will this work in the real world?"

6. "What is technically difficult or innovative in your system beyond integrating existing technologies?"
7. "What have YOU actually built, rather than proposed?"
8. "Give me one reason why CivicSync deserves to win."